

COURSE OUTLINE

PCI AI Project Controls Leader

The full syllabus. 13 domains, 61 knowledge areas, and the governed use of AI treated as part of the discipline rather than a chapter at the end.

Swipe for the whole thing →

WHAT YOU GET

A syllabus you can be examined on

13

domains

61

knowledge areas

26

sector case studies

Every technique arrives with **the conditions under which it fails**. A method you cannot break is a method you do not yet understand.

Finance, accounting and reporting

1

5 KAs

Foundations of accounting for project controls

The accounting model · Components of the financial statements · Accrual accounting and the matching concept · Cost provisions and cost accruals · Chart of accounts and cost coding for projects

2

5 KAs

Financial reporting and the standards

The reporting framework · IFRS 15 Revenue from Contracts with Customers · Revenue recognition beyond the basics · Other relevant standards for project controls · Management reporting versus statutory reporting

3

5 KAs

Budgeting and forecasting

Budgeting fundamentals · Cost estimation · The time-phased budget, or cost baseline (planned value) · Forecasting · Cash-flow forecasting

4

4 KAs

Performance management, variance analysis and management reporting

Performance management principles · Variance analysis · Management reporting · Data visualisation and storytelling for controls

Project management

5	Cost management and cost control
4 KAs	The cost management framework · The cost control cycle · Cost breakdown and control accounts · Change control and cost impact
6	Earned value management and forecasting
4 KAs	EVM fundamentals · Variances and performance indices · Forecasting with EVM: the EAC family · Integrating cost and schedule, limitations, earned schedule
7	Contracts, commercial management, BoQ, invoicing and revenue
5 KAs	Types of contract · Contract management · Bills of quantities · Invoicing and applications for payment · Revenue recognition in the commercial cycle
8	Project management lifecycle
6 KAs	Initiating · Planning · Executing · Monitoring and controlling · Closing · Development approaches: predictive, iterative, incremental and adaptive

Delivery, schedule, process and risk

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| 9
6 KAs | Agile, Scrum and adaptive delivery for project controls
Agile foundations · The Scrum framework in depth · Backlogs, estimation and agile metrics · Kanban, Lean and scaling · Agile cost control, forecasting and earned value · Hybrid delivery and agile governance |
| 10
4 KAs | Project scheduling, in depth
Schedule development · Network analysis and the critical path method · Schedule compression and resourcing · Progress measurement and schedule control |
| 11
3 KAs | Business process cycles
Order-to-cash · Procure-to-pay · Internal control and segregation of duties |
| 12
3 KAs | Risk management for project controls
The risk framework · The risk process · Contingency and management reserve |
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PART THREE · 20% OF THE BODY OF KNOWLEDGE

AI, governed

13

7 KAs

AI for project controls and project management

AI foundations for professionals · Data: the fuel · Prompting and working with generative AI · AI tool categories for project controls and PM · AI applied across the project-controls lifecycle · Governance, ethics, risk and assurance of AI · Building an AI-augmented project-controls capability

The largest domain in the volume, and the reason the credential exists in this form. It ends where every automated output should end: with **a named human who verified it.**

WHAT SITS BEHIND THE SYLLABUS

113 standards. 532 process requirements.

Each states its purpose, who owns the decision, what evidence must exist, what practice is prohibited, what triggers escalation, **what AI may never decide, approve or certify** — and a compliance test an assessor can actually perform.

They are certification requirements established by the Institute. They are not legislation, and nothing here is legal, tax or accounting advice.

THE PRINCIPLE BEHIND ALL OF IT

**AI proposes.
The professional
verifies, decides
and remains
accountable.**

Full outline and the three Bodies of Knowledge at projectcontrolsinstitute.org